

Sentences

- 1 Caecilius est in atrio.
- 2 amicus Caecilius salutat.
- 3 Metella est in atrio.
- 4 amicus Metella salutat.
- 5 Quintus est in atrio.
- 6 amicus Quintum salutat.
- 7 servus est in atrio.
- 8 amicus servum salutat.
- 9 canis est in atrio.
- 10 amicus canem salutat.
- 11 coquus est in culina.
- 12 Metella culinam intrat.
- 13 Grumio laborat.
- 14 Metella Grumionem spectat.
- 15 cibus est paratus.
- 16 Metella cibum gustat.
- 17 Grumio est anxius.
- 18 Metella Grumionem laudat.
- 19 amicus est in horto.
- 20 Metella amicum vocat.

Reading

mercator

amicus Caecilium visitat. amicus est mercator. mercator villam intrat. Clemens est in atrio. Clemens mercatorem salutat. Caecilius est in tablino. Caecilius pecuniam numerat. Caecilius est argentarius. amicus tablinum intrat. Caecilius surgit.

"salve!" Caecilius mercatorem salutat.

"salve!" mercator respondet.

Caecilius triclinium intrat. amicus quoque intrat. amicus in lecto recumbit. argentarius in lecto recumbit. Grumio in culina cantat. Grumio pavonem coquit. coquus est laetus. Caecilius coquum audit. Caecilius non est laetus. Caecilius cenam exspectat. amicus cenam exspectat. Caecilius Grumionem vituperat.

in triclinio

Grumio triclinium intrat. Grumio pavonem portat. Clemens triclinium intrat. Clemens vinum portat. Caecilius pavonem gustat.

"pavo est optimus!" Caecilius clamat.

mercator quoque pavonem gustat. mercator cenam Laudat. dominus coquum Laudat. Grumio exit. ancilla intrat. ancilla suaviter cantat. ancilla dominum delectate. ancilla mercatorem delectat. mox dominus dormit. amicus quoque dormit.

Guio triclinium intrat et circumspectat. coquus cibum in mensa videt. Grumio cibum consumit et vinum bibit! Caecilius Grumionem non videt. coquus in triclinio magnifice cenat.

coquus ancillam spectat. ancilla Grumionem delectate. Grumio ancillam delectate. Grumio est laetissimus.

Vocab

mercator

mercator, *merchant*

amicus, *friend*

visitat, *is visiting*

villam, *house*

Salutat, *greet*s

pecuniam, *money*

numerat, *is counting*

argentarius, *banker*

salve, *hello*

respondet, *replies*

quoque, *also, too*

in lecto, *on a couch*

recumbit, *reclines*

cantat, *is singing*

pavonem, *peacock*

coquit, *is cooking*

laetus, *happy*

audit, *hears, listens to*

non est, *is not*

cenam, *dinner*

expectat, *is waiting for*

vituperat, *tells off, curses*

in triclinio

portat, *is carrying*

vinum, *wine*

gustat, *tastes*

optimus, *very good, excellent*

laudat, *praises*

dominus, *master*

ancilla, *slave-girl*

suaviter, *sweetly*

delectat, *pleases*

mox, *soon*

et, *and*

videt, *sees*

consumit, *eats*

magnifice, *magnificently, in style*

cenat, *eats dinner, dines*

spectat, *looks at*

laetissimus, *very happy*

Grammar

About the Language

A Words like **Metella**, **Caecilius**, and **mercator** are known as nouns. They often indicate people or animals (e.g. **ancilla**, **canis**), places (e.g. **villa**, **hortus**), and things (e.g. **cena**, **cibus**).

B You have now met two forms of the same noun:

Metella – Metellam

Caecilius – Caecilium

mercator – mercatorem

C The different forms are known as the nominative case and the accusative case

nominative Metella Caecilius mercator

accusative Metellam Caecilium mercatorem

D If Metella does something, such as praising Grumio, the nominative **Metella** is used:

Metella Grumionem Laudat.

Metella praises Grumio.

E But if somebody else does something to Metella, the accusative **Metellam** is used:

amicus **Metellam** Salutat.

The friend greets Metella.

F Notice again the difference in word order between Latin and English:

coquus culinam intrat.

The cook enters the kitchen.

Clemens vinum portat.

Clemens carries the wine.

Practice

Practicing the Language

A Write out each Latin sentence, completing it with a suitable word or phrase from the box. Then translate the sentence. Use each phrase only once. For example:

canis stat.

canis in via stat.

The dog is standing in the street.

scribit

amicus

in culina

sedet

servus

in via

1 Grumio coquit.

2 in horto laborat.

3 mercator in tablino

4 Cerberus dormit.

5 Metella in atrio

6 in triclino cenat.

B Write out each Latin sentence, completing it with the correct word from the parentheses.

Then translate the sentence. For example:

amicus Caecilium (sedet, visitat).

amicus Caecilium visitat.

A friend visits Caecilius.

1 Caecilius pecuniam (numerat, dormit).

2 Clemens vinum (laborat, portat).

3 aniclla hortum (intrat, gustat).

4 Metella mercatorem (salutat, cantat).

5 Quintus cenam (visitat, consumit).

6 servus villam (dormit, intrat, portat).

7 amicus Grumionem (spectat, stat, recumbit).

8 mater filium (surgit, dormit, vituperat).

9 mercator canem (sedet, consumit, audit).

10 dominus ancillam (scribit, laudat, numerat).

C Write out each sentence, choosing the noun that correctly completes the sentence. Trsnlate each sentence.

- 1 (servus, servum) in culina coquit.
- 2 mater (mercator, mercatorem) Salutat.
- 3 (ancilla, ancillam) suaviter cantat.
- 4 servus (cena, cenam) gustat.
- 5 Grumio (ancilla, ancillam) delectat.
- 6 (dominus, dominum) dormit.

D Translate into English:

amicus

amicus Grumionem visitat. amicus est servus. servus villam intrat. Clemens est in atrio. servus Clementem videt. Clemens servum Salutat. servus culinam intrat. servus culinam circumspectat. Grumio non est in culina. servus cibum videt. cibus est paratus! servus cibum gustat. cibus est optimus.

Grumio culinam intrat. Grumio amicum videt. amicus cibum consumit! coquus est iratus.

“pestis! furcifer!” coquus clamat. coquus amicum vituperat.

paratus, *ready*

Culture

Daily Life

The day began early for Caecilius and the members of his household. He would usually get up at dawn. His slaves were up even earlier, sweeping, dusting, and polishing.

It did not take Caecilius long to dress. The first garment that he put on was his **tunica**, a tunic similar to a short-sleeved shirt, then his **toga**, a very large piece of woolen cloth arranged in folds, and finally his shoes, which were rather like modern sandals. A quick wash of the hands and face with cold water was enough at that time of the morning. Later he would visit a barber to be shaved, and in the afternoon he would enjoy a leisurely visit to the public baths.

His wife, Metella, also got up early. Over her tunica, she put on a **stola**, a full-length over-tunic. If she were going out, she would also wear a large rectangular shawl, called a **palla**. With the help of a skilled slave-woman, she did her hair in the latest style, put on her makeup, including powder, rouge, and mascara, and chose her jewelry from her large and varied collection. \

Breakfast was only a light snack, often just a cup of water and a piece of bread. The first duty of the day for Caecilius was to receive the respectful greetings of a number of poorer people and freedmen who had previously been his slaves. The **salutatio** or reception of these visitors took place in the atrium. Caecilius would hand out small sums of money to them. If they were in any kind of trouble, he gave them as much help and protection as he could. In return, they helped Caecilius in several ways. They might accompany him to show support on public occasions, and they might also be employed by him in business affairs. They were known as his **clientes**

(clients), and he was their **patronus** (patron). If, after seeing these visitors, he had no further business to conduct at home, Caecilius set out for the **forum** (market-place), where he spent the rest of the morning trading and banking.

Lunch was eaten at about midday, and it was also a light meal. It usually consisted of some meat or fish followed by fruit. Business ended soon after lunch. Caecilius would then have a short siesta before going to the baths. Towards the end of the afternoon, the main meal of the day began. This was called the **cena**.

During the winter, the family used the inner dining room near the atrium. In the summer, they would generally have preferred the dining room at the back of the house, which looked straight out onto the garden. Three couches were arranged around a **mensa** or circular table which, though small, was very elegantly carved and decorated. Each couch had places for three people. The diners reclined on the couches, leaning on their left elbow and taking food from the table with their right hand. The food was cut up by a slave before being served, and diners ate it with their fingers or a spoon. Forks were not used by the Romans.

By the time of our stories, the women of the family were present at the cena, usually reclining like the men. The meal was not hurried, for this was an occasion to talk and relax over good food. Women played an active role in the conversation, even on social occasions. If guests were invited, some form of entertainment was often provided.

Not all Romans reclined when eating dinner, but it was usual among rich or upper-class families. Poor people, slaves, children, and sometimes women would eat sitting up.

A Roman Dinner

The meal began with a first course of light dishes to whet the appetite. Eggs, fish, and cooked and raw vegetables were often served. Then came the main course in which a variety of meat dishes with different sauces and vegetables would be offered. Beef, pork, mutton, and poultry were all popular, and in preparing them the cook would do his best to show off his skill and imagination. Finally, the dessert was brought in, consisting of fruit, nuts, cheese, and sweet dishes. During the meal, wine produced locally from the vineyards on Mount Vesuvius was served, usually mixed with water. Women were expected to drink sparingly.

*Roman dinners were said to run **ab ovo usque ad mala** ("from eggs to apples"); this bowl of eggs has survived from Pompeii.*

Fish and other seafood were much enjoyed.

Many loaves of bread have been found in the ruins of Pompeii.

Many course ingredients – a rabbit and a chicken – hanging in a larder.

To round off the meal: the fruit bowl and the basket of figs.

